

PROGRAMME IMPACT STORIES

Affordable Housing Programme – Kenya

State Department for Housing and Urban Development

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INTRODUCTION

The Affordable Housing Programme is transforming lives and communities across Kenya. Below are real stories from beneficiaries whose lives have been changed through housing, skills training, and economic empowerment.

BENEFICIARY STORIES

1. Diana Mwange – From Laundry Worker to Certified Painter

Background: 35-year-old mother of three, Nairobi.

How She Benefited: Joined Mukuru Social Housing Project; learned paint mixing, preparation, and quality selection.

Her Words: *"My life has changed. I get an income from this project, and I am able to pay school fees for my children, clothe them as well as afford a decent house for them."*

Impact: Steady income, fulfilled childhood ambition, restored confidence.

2. Rossina Mbithe – From Slum to Homeowner

Background: Lived in Riara Mukuru informal settlement with two children.

How She Benefited: Received offer letter from Affordable Housing Board; among 1,080 beneficiaries given keys to Mukuru Estate.

Her Words: *"I never thought I would one day live in a decent house like the one in Mukuru."*

Impact: Secure home with electricity, security, drainage, and piped water.

3. Stephen Odhiambo – Welder Turned Homeowner

Background: Metal fabricator, Mukuru kwa Njenga slums.

How He Benefited: Self-help group contracted to make windows, doors, grills; later allocated a studio apartment.

His Words: *"Now I have piped water inside my house. Before I had to deal with a kerosene lamp, but now I have electricity and a gas connection."*

Impact: Piped water, electricity, gas, secure playground for children.

4. Newton Kinyua – 25-Year-Old Homeowner

Background: Born and bred in Mukuru kwa Njenga slums.

How He Benefited: Applied through Boma Yangu after saving KES 200 a day.

His Words: *"I am excited about this project because it is a major turning point in my life. The allocation process was free and fair."*

Impact: Became a homeowner at 25.

5. Naomi Waithira ("Mama Njoro") – Banana Seller Turned Homeowner

Background: Retail banana hawker, lived in waterlogged iron-sheet house.

How She Benefited: Registered by Affordable Housing Board team and started saving.

Her Words: *"I am a living proof that the government works for the poor. Who thought a banana seller could own a house in Nairobi?"*

Impact: Better health, clean water, electricity, gas cooker, private toilet.

6. Perpetua Muthoni – From Mama Fua to Certified Painter

Background: Single mother of two, mobile clothes washer.

How She Benefited: Joined Bahati AHP project; obtained NITA certification in painting.

Her Words: *"Before this project, I led a hopeless life that I was ashamed of. My parents are now proud of me."*

Impact: Certified painter, started shoe business, caring for parents and children.

7. Vernon Nyaberi – From Garage to Construction Site

Background: Motor vehicle mechanic with downturn in work.

How He Benefited: Joined Bahati AHP project and upgraded skills.

His Words: *"After joining the Affordable Housing Project, my earnings have tripled."*

Impact: Tripled earnings, started horticultural farming employing two laborers.

8. Martin Mbogo Muritu – Person with Disability Finds Dignity

Background: 58-year-old with eye disability.

How He Benefited: Specialized in landscaping and gardening at Bahati AHP.

His Words: *"I no longer look at myself as disabled but a respected landscaper and gardener. AHP has restored my dignity as a man and a professional worker."*

Impact: Specialized skills, purpose, income, and dignity.

9. Paul Mwangi – From Dropout to Carpenter Team Leader

Background: Dropped out of campus due to lack of tuition fees.

How He Benefited: Joined Kikuyu AHP site and progressed to supervising a team.

His Words: *"This is not like the jobs that disappear after a few weeks. Here, I have consistent income. I can plan my life."*

Impact: Consistent income, plans to return to school, leadership skills.

10. Milcah Kaheli – From Laundry Worker to Security Officer

Background: Earned KES 250 from laundry work to support elderly mother.

How She Benefited: Joined Elburgon AHP project and became a security officer.

Her Words: *"My child now attends school regularly. My mother's health has improved"*

and she is able to run her business fully."

Impact: Steady income, invested in mother's business, supporting siblings.

11. Josephat Danjeru – From Intern to Foreman

Background: Started as intern at Ruiru AHP.

How He Benefited: Completed diploma and promoted to foreman.

His Words: *"This programme has enabled me to cater for my needs and support my parents."*

Impact: Promoted to foreman, saving for university fees.

12. Dorcas Kamene – From Unskilled Worker to Certified Steel Fixer

Background: Started as unskilled worker.

How She Benefited: Through Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) programme.

Her Words: *"I am not just learning; I am providing for my children. I am proud to have my skills recognized officially."*

Impact: Certified steel fixer, reads engineering blueprints.

TESTIMONIALS FROM HOMEOWNERS

Jacob Waweru: *"At first, many believed the Affordable Housing Programme was a scam. I have no regrets for trusting the government. I pay Kes 3,900 for my unit monthly."*

Elizabeth Mutava: *"Despite having worked and retired last year, this dream has become a reality. The Affordable Housing Programme is real."*

Wibroad Otieno: *"I have moved away from paying rent and facing threats from landlords to becoming a homeowner."*

SUMMARY OF IMPACT

- **Housing:** Over 1,080+ units handed over.
- **Employment:** Thousands of jobs created in construction, painting, welding, security, landscaping, and more.
- **Skills Development:** NITA certifications, RPL recognition, leadership roles.

- **Dignity & Empowerment:** Beneficiaries report restored confidence, family stability, and long-term planning.
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Prepared by the State Department for Housing and Urban Development, Kenya

For more information, visit Boma Yangu portal.